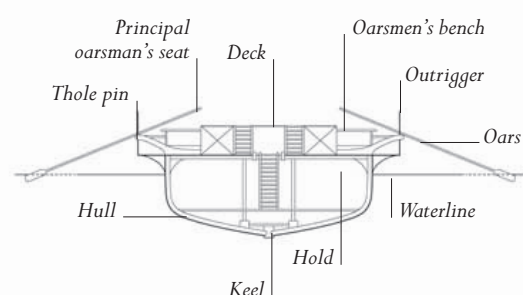


STERN, POOP, AND HOLD

The ship's most striking feature is its ornate stern. This was painstakingly recreated from a contemporary description. Although elaborately decorated, the poop deck became the centre of resistance if the galley was boarded in battle, with fighting men clustering there to defend their flag and commander. The *Galera Real* had a larger hold than ordinary war galleys, with plenty of space for stores.



CROSS-SECTION

GALLEY HOLD



▲ SPACIOUS HOLD

The hold stored food, drink, weapons, armour, sailcloth, spars, clothing, ropes, and a number of lockable chests in which the ship's gentlemen kept their possessions. There was also a gunpowder room and a surgery.



▲ BASIC STORES

Grain, wine, and water were always in store. Fresh vegetables and bread were taken aboard whenever possible.

GALLEY STERN



▲ DECORATED STERN

The *Galera Real* was built in Barcelona in 1568 and decorated in Seville. The frieze at the top of the stern shows Hercules in the Garden of the Hesperides.

Below, the two lions hold the coats of arms of Austria and the Order of the Golden Fleece, while the four female figures represent Christian virtues.

► GILDED BALUSTER

Every tiny detail around the stern, where the admiral resided in the poop, is richly carved and gilded or painted.

► EAGLE

The gilded eagles on the stern are a reference to the Roman Empire and Christian Europe's desire to win back Rome's former lands from Ottoman control.



◀ FACE OF MEDUSA

The snake-headed gorgon Medusa stares out from the stern of the *Galera Real*, deflecting evil and bringing destruction on the ships of Don John's enemies.

